

Topic: **Life and Importance of Holy Prophet (PBUH): Life in Makkah**

Sub Topic: **5th Year of Hijrah**

Q (a) Give an account of the battles of Khandaq (Trench).

[10]

Structure of Answer

Para 1:

- After getting exiled from Madinah in 4th A.H, Banu Nazir's leaders Salaam, Hayy bin Akhtab and Kanaanah launched a provocative campaign and visited every corner of Arabian desert in order to seek help against Muslims of Madinah. They visited Quraysh and shared their plan of crushing Muslims. Quraysh immediately ensured their full support. Jews then approached Banu Saleem, Banu Ghatfaan, Banu Marrah, Ashja, Banu Asad and other Bedouin tribes and were able to form an immense army consisting 10000 to 12000 warriors equipped with best possible weapons and supplies.
- Prophet (PBUH) when got to know about this invasion plan he called a council meeting to discuss defense plan for Madinah. Among all other suggestions, Prophet (PBUH) liked Salman Farsi's (RA) suggestion of digging a trench. Eastern, western and southern sides of Madinah were naturally protected from any major invasion as there were thick gardens. Only northern side was a plain ground that could let Quraysh army enter the city.

Para 2:

- The main trench that was dug by Prophet (PBUH) along with 3000 companions was approximately 3.5-mile-long as it started from Harrah and stretched till Mount of Sala'. Despite severe shortage of Food Prophet (PBUH) himself would participate in digging trench along with companions. Then people from Quba and other neighborhoods of Madinah dug separate trenches for their own safety. This whole process took 3 weeks and Madinah became safe from any invasion.
- As the immense army was a combination of different groups of different tribes, this battle is also called Battle of Al-Ahzaab (The Groups). Sufyan bin Abd Shams, Uyayna, Harith, Masood and Talha and Abu Sufyan were commanders of their respective contingents and Abu Sufyan was also declared as Commander in chief of whole Army. This army reached Madinah on the last day of Shawwal, 5 AH (626 AD).
 - ❖ Ref: "[Remember] when they came at you from above you and from below you, and when eyes shifted [in fear]..." [33:10]
- But they were so surprised and confused to see the trench as this was whole new thing they ever encountered. On the other hand, 3000 Muslims were ready to defend Madinah. Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) would designate group of companions on different points of trench in order to keep invaders from crossing it by chance.
- One day 5 warriors from Quraysh Ikramah, Naufal, Dharraar, Hubairah and Amr bin Abdood crossed the trench and challenged the Muslims. Amr bin Abdood was the bravest of them all. Hazrat Ali (RA)



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killed him after a fierce encounter while he himself suffered a severe wound on his forehead. Naufal fell in ditch and was also killed while other ran away.

- Banu Quraizah were approached by Quraysh to engage Muslims in internal war so they could get a chance to cross the trench. Luckily their plan was foiled.
- Naeem bin Masood was member of Quraysh army he approached Prophet (PBUH) and embraced Islam and took responsibility of creating misunderstanding between invaders and leaking their plans.
- One night Quraysh were struck by a horrible sandstorm that destroyed their camps, spoiled their kitchen system, scattered their livestock and above all destroyed their left-out morale.
 - ❖ Ref: "O you who have believed, remember the favor of Allah upon you when armies came to [attack] you and We sent upon them a wind and armies [of angels] you did not see...." [33:9]
- Finally Quraysh decided to retreat on 23 Zul-Qa'da 5 AH (626 AD). Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said: "Now we will attack them, they won't" [Ghazwaat-un-Nabi]

Para 3:

- After Quraysh retreat when Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) was about to take off his armor, Jibrael came and said:
 - ❖ "Angels are still in their armors"
- Prophet (PBUH) got the idea about what is Allah's plan so he ordered to march on Banu Quraiza and besieged their forts. After 15 days on 7th Zul-Hajj 5 AH they surrendered on a condition that Saad bin Muadh (RA) will be their judge and according to decision taken by Saad (RA), Banu Quraizah were punished.
- Muslims emerged as a decisive power that defended their city against all odds. Whole Arab was observing this war and was expecting the end of Islam and Muslims but the way Muslims defended and defeated Quraysh made them an emerging power of Arab and inspired a lot of neutral tribes.

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